

TIMELINE

- **December 3, 1826** Born to George McClellan and Elizabeth Steinmetz Brinton in Philadelphia.
- **1840** Enrolls at the University of Pennsylvania.
- **1842-1846** Studies at West Point, emerging second in a class of 58, and joins the prestigious Corps of Engineers.
- **1847** Wins two brevets for gallantry during the War with Mexico.
- **1853** McClellan assigned to survey duty in Washington state's Cascade Mountains for the purpose of building a transcontinental railroad.
- **1855** Serves on the Delafield Commission sent to observe the Crimean War.
- **1857** Becomes chief engineer of the Illinois Central Railroad.
- **1860** Marries Mary Ellen Marcy, the daughter of Brigadier General Randolph B. Marcy, his former commander.
- **June-July 1861** McClellan leads a successful campaign in western Virginia.
- **November 1861** Replaces the retiring General Winfield Scott as general-in-chief.
- **March 1862** McClellan is relieved of his post as general-in-chief of all U.S. armies so he can focus on the Army of the Potomac.
- **March 17, 1862** Army of the Potomac sails for Fort Monroe at the tip of the Virginia Peninsula. Start of the Peninsula Campaign.
- **April 1862** McClellan's advance toward Richmond is delayed at Yorktown by Confederate deception and his own procrastination.
- **May 31-June 1, 1862** Johnston attacks McClellan's forces at Seven Pines and is repulsed.
- **June 25-July 2, 1862** During the Seven Days Battles, Lee pushes McClellan away from Richmond to the James River. McClellan inflicts serious losses on Lee but loses his nerve.
- **August 29-30, 1862** Union defeat at Second Bull Run. McClellan is called back to reorganize the battered Army of the Potomac.
- **September 17, 1862** Despite enjoying large numerical superiority, McClellan fails to defeat Lee at Antietam.
- **November 1862** Lincoln finally loses patience and relieves McClellan of his post. He holds no further military command.
- **October 1863** McClellan enters politics as a Democrat.